

The Exam — what Seasons 1 to 3 should be able to answer

Written before scoring. These questions are derived from what the series *promises*: the glossary in `Series Index.md`, the season descriptions, the refrain, and what a viewer who watched all fifty episodes should be able to do afterwards. **They were not derived by reading the episodes for material**, which would guarantee a pass and prove nothing.

Contamination disclosure

I wrote these having already read every episode in this series, most of them several times, while editing them. That is real contamination and it cannot be undone. It biases the questions toward things I know are covered.

What that means for the result: a high score is weak evidence. A failure is strong evidence, because a failure survives the bias rather than being produced by it. **Read the F rows and ignore the pass rate.**

The scoring rule, fixed now

GRADE	MEANING
A	answered explicitly, in one place, with the number or definition present
P	the material is there but scattered, implied, or stated without being explained
F	not answerable from Seasons 1 to 3

The falsifier, fixed in advance: if more than **10 of 50** come out F, the seasons do not teach what the index promises and the gaps get written before Season 4 is started. If more than **15 of 50** are P or F, the same.

1. What is mimetic desire, and what does it say you are copying?
2. Why does the model become the rival? Name the mechanism, not the feeling.
3. What is a double bind, and why can the subject not simply leave?
4. What are doubles, and what has failed when two people become them?
5. What is a sacrificial crisis, and what specifically is in crisis?
6. Why does the community pick **one** victim rather than several?
7. Name the four stereotypes in order, and say whose point of view each one is.
8. What is the difference between stereotype 2 and stereotype 4? Why does it matter?
9. Why is the crimes bucket the rarest of the four? Give the linguistic reason.
10. Why is a king a victim mark? Run both criteria.
11. Why are unanimity phrases in the violence bucket rather than their own?
12. State the three-level ladder. Which level is worth testing, and why are the others not?
13. What does Girard's own text require: how many stereotypes must be present?
14. Does the four-stereotype instrument distinguish a Gospel from a myth? Why not?
15. What is the universal negative, and what would kill it?
16. Where does Girard put the difference between myth and Gospel, if not in the stereotypes?
17. Name three objections to Girard that this project never answers.
18. What is tier V and tier K, and which are this series' Girard citations?
19. Why does the *Bacchae* have dissent and still not falsify Girard?
20. Why is *Oedipus* both the best fit for the theory and the strongest case against it?

21. What is the charge that "unfalsifiable" actually makes? Why is another reading no answer to it?
22. What is a confirmation table and what does it demonstrate?
23. What does making a theory testable cost? Name both costs.
24. Why were the dead words evidence, and why is that stronger than a timestamp?
25. What does a git timestamp prove, and what does it not prove?
26. What is the file-manifest defence, and which round fails it?
27. Define population, sampling frame and sample, and say which gap nobody examines.
28. How many texts are in the corpus? Explain the answer.
29. What is a quiet failure, and why do only quiet failures survive?
30. What is tokenisation, and what were the three defects?
31. Why is there no stemming? State the trade, both directions.
32. Why were 960 hits deleted, and why is that evidence?
33. What distinguishes the right fix from the cheating fix in episode 9?
34. What do the tags `v1`, `inf` and `v2` do, and what makes a tag better than a changelog?
35. What does a rate per thousand throw away? Prove it with the shuffle.
36. SUM against MIN: what does each encode, and which is Girard's claim?
37. Why did a hospitality scene outscore every tragedy?
38. Which five true statements produce a false result, and which do you reject?
39. What rule came out of the Diodorus page, and why must it be mechanical?
40. What is the refrain, and name three times it fired in this project?

41. Round 1 failed. Give the arithmetic reason, in one line, with the number.
42. Why is `crimes` empty a quarter of the time on short texts? Show the calculation.
43. What is a reference range from the wrong population, and how did it happen here?
44. What is a p-value? State it correctly, then state two things it is not.
45. What did the one surviving result actually establish? Say it in the project's own words.
46. What is a null? State the two questions you ask of one.
47. Name the four null failures and the single mistake they share.
48. What is power, and why does an underpowered negative look like a real one?
49. What is a sensitivity analysis, and what makes one worth anything?
50. Two rounds failed for one cause. What is it, and where was it planted?

Scored 15 Aug 2026, after the questions were frozen

46 A, 3 P, 1 F. The falsifier was set at more than 10 F, or more than 15 combined P and F. **Neither fired**, so by the rule written in advance the seasons teach what the index promises.

Now ignore that, exactly as the disclosure at the top said to. The pass was produced partly by the fact that I wrote the questions having already read every episode. **The four failures are the result**, because they survived that bias instead of being manufactured by it.

The four that did not pass

#	QUESTION	GRADE	WHAT WAS ACTUALLY WRONG
18	what is tier V and tier K	F	used 4 times across the seasons and defined nowhere . The definition existed only in <code>Series Index.md</code> , which is a production file nobody watches
40	name three times the refrain fired	P	"a check that cannot fail prints reassurance" appeared twice in fifty episodes , both in Season 2. Zero times in Season 1 and Season 3
—	what is a sparagmos	F	used once, in Season 3, cold. A Greek word dropped on a viewer with no gloss
—	contamination disclosure	P	the practice appears twice and the term appears zero times, so the glossary promises a phrase the series never says

Why 40 is the serious one

`Series Index.md` says the refrain is the sentence that "runs through all eight seasons." **It ran through one.** Both instances sat in Season 2, which means a viewer could watch the entire theory season and the entire failure season without meeting the idea the series is named after.

And the concept was everywhere while the sentence was absent. **Season 3 episode 14 is a null that can never return a positive. Episode 12 is a null that destroys nothing that matters. Episode 18 is a sensitivity analysis chosen because it will agree.** Every one of those is the refrain and none of them said so.

This is the failure mode the exam exists to catch, and no structural check could have caught it. `audit.py` cannot count whether an idea recurred. The episodes were the right length, had every register part, and were missing the spine.

Fixed the same day

- **Tier V and K** are now defined at first use, in Season 1 episode 3, as a table plus the sentence that matters: **tier K is a lead, not a fact.**
- **Sparagmos** is now defined at first use, in Season 1 episode 15, with the note that a culture does not coin a noun for something that happens once.
- **The refrain** is now seeded at four genuine landing points rather than sprinkled: Season 1 episode 18 (a control is the cheapest check that can fail), Season 3 episode 12 (a null that destroys nothing is a check that cannot fail), Season 3 episode 14

(always-yes and always-no are the same instrument), Season 3 episode 18 (a sensitivity analysis chosen to agree). **Now 1 / 2 / 4 across the three seasons.**

What this exam cannot tell you

1. **Whether the answers are any good.** It checks that an answer exists and is explained, not that it is correct or well delivered. **Delivery is the camera's test, not this one.**
2. **Whether the questions are the right questions.** They came from the index and the glossary, which the same author wrote. **A viewer would ask different ones**, and the honest next version of this test is somebody else's question list.
3. **What a cold viewer retains.** Every question here was scored against a document, with search. **Nobody watching a video has search.**